Pass the CSA in 4 weeks

A week-by-week plan built around the ServiceNow Administration Fundamentals e-book. Plan on about 1.5 to 2 hours a day, five or six days a week.

Ground rules

- **The e-book is the source of truth.** There are no questions on the exam that aren't covered in the book. Read all of it.
- **Take detailed notes.** Writing or typing them yourself is what makes the material stick.
- **Study by weight.** Database Management (27%), Collaboration (20%), and Self-Service & Automation (20%) make up two-thirds of the exam.
- **Use practice questions to find gaps, not to memorize.** Real exam questions change. Understanding beats recognition.
- **Get a Personal Developer Instance** at developer.servicenow.com before day 1.

Week 1: Read and take notes

Get through the first half of the e-book. Skip the labs for now; this week is about understanding.

Days 1 to 5	Read at least 2 modules a day and take detailed notes. Write down every table name, role, and module path you see.
Day 6	Reread your notes. Turn the facts you keep forgetting into flash cards.
Day 7	Rest.

End of week check: you can explain the difference between a user, group, and role, and between a list and a form, without looking.

Week 2: Finish the book, then do the labs

Finish reading, then put your hands on the platform.

Days 1 to 3	Finish reading the remaining modules with the same note-taking. Read the "Note" boxes and lists closely; tricky questions often come from them.
Days 4 and 5	Start the labs in your PDI. Challenge yourself not to use the step-by-step guide; open it only when you're stuck.
Day 6	Continue the labs. Redo any lab you needed the guide for.
Day 7	Rest.

End of week check: you've read every module and started the labs.

Week 3: Labs and the blueprint

Finish every lab, then aim your study at the heaviest domains.

Days 1 and 2	Finish all remaining labs without the step-by-step guide.
Day 3	Print the exam blueprint. Rate yourself 1 to 5 on each domain. Read the Database Management section of the study guide and build a table, a relationship, and an ACL in your PDI.
Day 4	Study guide: Collaboration and Self-Service & Automation. Build a catalog item with a variable set, and a flow with an approval.
Day 5	Study guide: Data Migration, Instance Configuration, and Navigation. Import a small spreadsheet with a transform map and a coalesce field.
Day 6	Visit developer.servicenow.com: work through the admin learning plan topics you rated lowest, and skim the ServiceNow glossary to get comfortable with the lingo.
Day 7	Rest.

End of week check: no domain is rated below 3, and you've done each high-weight task in a PDI at least once.

Week 4: Practice, fix gaps, review

Test under exam conditions and close the gaps you find.

Day 1	Take a timed exam simulation (60 questions, 90 minutes) with answers hidden. Note your weakest domains.
Day 2	Go back to the e-book and your notes for your two weakest domains. Practice them in your PDI. Then do single-domain practice for each.
Day 3	Take a second timed simulation. Retake every missed question and look up why the right answer is right.
Day 4	Work through the full question bank with answers shown, a domain at a time.
Day 5	Final simulation. Review the study guide’s table names and rapid-fire recall. Aim for 85% or higher before you sit the exam.
Day 6	Light review of flash cards only. Sleep well.
Day 7	Exam day. Read every question carefully, and select exactly as many answers as it asks for.

Habits that help

- **Find a study group or accountability partner.** Explaining a topic to someone else is the fastest way to find out whether you really know it.
- **Make flash cards** for table names, roles, and module paths.
- **Take breaks.** Short breaks every 45 to 50 minutes keep your focus sharp.
- **Reward yourself** when you hit a weekly checkpoint, and set a consequence if you skip a day.
- **Behind schedule?** Don’t skip reading to get to practice questions. Push the exam date instead.